FILED
JUL 20 2026
CLERK, U.S. DISTRICT COURT
NORTHERN DISTRICT OF CALIFORNIA

UNITED STATES DISTRICT COURT

NORTHERN DISTRICT OF CALIFORNIA

BRENDAN NGEHSI NEWANFORBI,

Plaintiff,

v.

SHANNON SMITH, ET AL,

Defendant.

Case No. 26-cv-07504-LJC

ORDER SETTING INITIAL CASE MANAGEMENT CONFERENCE AND ADR DEADLINES

This action is assigned to the Honorable Lisa J. Cisneros.

Service of documents. When serving the complaint or notice of removal, the plaintiff or removing defendant must serve on all other parties a copy of this order and the supplementary material specified in Civil Local Rule 4-2.

Magistrate Judge Jurisdiction. This case has been randomly assigned to a magistrate judge, who, with written consent of all parties, may conduct all proceedings in a case, including all pretrial and trial proceedings, entry of judgment and post-trial motions, with appeal directly to the United States Court of Appeals for the Ninth Circuit. See "Consenting to the Jurisdiction of a Magistrate Judge" on the Court's webpage at www.cand.uscourts.gov for more information.

Plaintiff or the removing party must complete and file the attached form "Consent or Declination to Magistrate Judge Jurisdiction" (also available at www.cand.uscourts.gov/forms) within 14 days of case initiation, and all other parties must do so within 14 days of appearing in the case, or as otherwise ordered by the Clerk or magistrate judge.

Availability of Alternative Dispute Resolution. This action is assigned to the Alternative Dispute Resolution (ADR) Multi-Option Program governed by ADR Local Rule 3. Counsel and clients shall familiarize themselves with that rule and with the material entitled "Dispute Resolution Procedures in the Northern District of California" on the Court's ADR webpage at www.cand.uscourts.gov/adr.

Important case management dates. Counsel must comply with the dates listed below unless the judge otherwise orders.

Case Management Event	Deadline
File Certification of Conflicts and Interested Entities or Persons. (See Civil L.R. 3-15)	Upon first appearance (supplement as necessary)
Deadline to file ADR Certification. (See ADR L.R. 3)	10/1/2026
Deadline to meet and confer re: initial disclosures, early settlement, ADR process selection, and discovery plan. (See F.R. Civ. P. 26(f))	10/1/2026
Deadline to make initial disclosures. (See F.R. Civ. P. 26(a)(1))	10/15/2026
Deadline to file Joint Case Management Statement. (See Standing Order for All Judges of the Northern District of California)	10/15/2026
Initial Case Management Conference location: **To be held by Zoom. Go to cand.uscourts.gov/ljc for Zoom link.**	10/22/2026 at 1:30 PM

NOTE: If the date of the initial case management conference is changed, all the above deadlines are adjusted accordingly unless otherwise ordered.

UNITED STATES DISTRICT COURT

NORTHERN DISTRICT OF CALIFORNIA

BRENDAN NGEHSI NEWANFORBI, Plaintiff, v. SHANNON SMITH, ET AL, Defendant.	Case No. 26-cv-07504-LJC **CONSENT OR DECLINATION TO MAGISTRATE JUDGE JURISDICTION**

INSTRUCTIONS: Please indicate below by checking **one** of the two boxes whether you (if you are the party) or the party you represent (if you are an attorney in the case) choose(s) to consent or decline to magistrate judge jurisdiction in this matter. Sign this form below your selection.

☐ **CONSENT to Magistrate Judge Jurisdiction**

In accordance with the provisions of 28 U.S.C. § 636(c), I voluntarily **consent** to have a United States magistrate judge conduct all further proceedings in this case, including trial and entry of final judgment. I understand that appeal from the judgment shall be taken directly to the United States Court of Appeals for the Ninth Circuit.

OR

☐ **DECLINE Magistrate Judge Jurisdiction**

In accordance with the provisions of 28 U.S.C. § 636(c), I **decline** to have a United States magistrate judge conduct all further proceedings in this case and I hereby request that this case be reassigned to a United States district judge.

DATE: _____ NAME: _____

_____
Signature or "/s/"

COUNSEL FOR
(OR "PRO SE"): _____

E-filing Self-Registration Instructions for Pro Se Litigants

Pro se litigants whose names appear on existing cases before this court may register to become ECF users and may file documents electronically. Case-opening documents (like complaints and petitions) must still be filed on paper at the Court's front counter or by mail or delivery service.

If you have an existing pro se e-filing account, and you wish to e-file in another case in which your name is listed, send an email to ECFHelpDesk@cand.uscourts.gov to link your account to that case.

Parties representing themselves are not required to e-file, but many choose to do so. There are no registration costs and no fees for e-filing. To learn more about e-filing registration and the technical requirements to e-file, go to www.cand.uscourts.gov/e-file/

Advantages to E-filing:

1. You can e-file from any computer.
2. You do not have to go to the courthouse to file your court papers.
3. You have until 11:59 PM on the day your filing is due to e-file (instead of 4:00 p.m. for delivery to the Clerk's Office for paper filings).
4. You do not need to mail paper copies to the court or other parties.
5. You will likely have more time to respond to any motion instead of having to wait for your copy to arrive by mail.
6. You receive one free copy of any e-filed documents through the notice of electronic filing.

Possible Drawbacks to E-filing:

1. You must have all necessary hardware and software required to e-file, so there may be some initial cost.
2. You may require some training in how to convert documents to PDFs, and how to e-file documents. Free training on this is available on the court's website.
3. You will not receive documents in paper, so you will be responsible for checking your e-mail frequently for case updates and saving copies of e-filed documents.
4. While you get one free look at the electronic version of any document filed in your case, you will be charged if you access the document electronically more than once. (Note there is no fee for viewing judicial opinions no matter how many times you access it electronically.)
5. If you have more than $30.00 of charges for viewing documents in a quarterly billing cycle, you will be charged. See Electronic Public Access Fee Schedule for more explanation.

STANDING ORDER FOR ALL JUDGES OF THE NORTHERN DISTRICT OF CALIFORNIA

CONTENTS OF JOINT CASE MANAGEMENT STATEMENT

All judges of the Northern District of California require identical information in Joint Case Management Statements filed pursuant to Civil Local Rule 16-9. The parties must include the following information in their statement which, except in unusually complex cases, should not exceed ten pages:

1. Jurisdiction and Service: The basis for the court's subject matter jurisdiction over plaintiff's claims and defendant's counterclaims, whether any issues exist regarding personal jurisdiction or venue, whether any parties remain to be served, and, if any parties remain to be served, a proposed deadline for service.
2. Facts: A brief chronology of the facts and a statement of the principal factual issues in dispute.
3. Legal Issues: A brief statement, without extended legal argument, of the disputed points of law, including reference to specific statutes and decisions.
4. Motions: All prior and pending motions, their current status, and any anticipated motions.
5. Amendment of Pleadings: The extent to which parties, claims, or defenses are expected to be added or dismissed and a proposed deadline for amending the pleadings.
6. Evidence Preservation: A brief report certifying that the parties have reviewed the Guidelines Relating to the Discovery of Electronically Stored Information ("ESI Guidelines"), and confirming that the parties have met and conferred pursuant to Fed. R. Civ. P. 26(f) regarding reasonable and proportionate steps taken to preserve evidence relevant to the issues reasonably evident in this action. *See ESI Guidelines 2.01 and 2.02, and Checklist for ESI Meet and Confer.*
7. Disclosures: Whether there has been full and timely compliance with the initial disclosure requirements of Fed. R. Civ. P. 26, and a description of the disclosures made.
8. Discovery: Discovery taken to date, if any, the scope of anticipated discovery, any proposed limitations or modifications of the discovery rules, a brief report on whether the parties have considered entering into a stipulated e-discovery order, a proposed discovery plan pursuant to Fed. R. Civ. P. 26(f), and any identified discovery disputes.
9. Class Actions: If a class action, a proposal for how and when the class will be certified, and whether all attorneys of record for the parties have reviewed the Procedural Guidance for Class Action Settlements.
10. Related Cases: Any related cases or proceedings pending before another judge of this court, or before another court or administrative body.
11. Relief: All relief sought through complaint or counterclaim, including the amount of any damages sought and a description of the bases on which damages are calculated. In addition, any party from whom damages are sought must describe the bases on which it contends damages should be calculated if liability is established.
12. Settlement and ADR: Prospects for settlement, ADR efforts to date, and a specific ADR plan for the case, including compliance with ADR L.R. 3-5 and a description of key discovery or motions necessary to position the parties to negotiate a resolution.
13. Other References: Whether the case is suitable for reference to binding arbitration, a special master, or the Judicial Panel on Multidistrict Litigation.

14. Narrowing of Issues: Issues that can be narrowed by agreement or by motion, suggestions to expedite the presentation of evidence at trial (e.g., through summaries or stipulated facts), and any request to bifurcate issues, claims, or defenses. The parties shall jointly identify (in bold or highlight) one to three issues which are the most consequential to the case and discuss how resolution of these issues may be expedited.

15. Expedited Trial Procedure: Whether this is the type of case that can be handled under the Expedited Trial Procedure of General Order No. 64 Attachment A. If all parties agree, they shall instead of this Statement, file an executed Agreement for Expedited Trial and a Joint Expedited Case Management Statement, in accordance with General Order No. 64 Attachments B and D.

16. Scheduling: Proposed dates for designation of experts, discovery cutoff, hearing of dispositive motions, pretrial conference and trial.

17. Trial: Whether the case will be tried to a jury or to the court and the expected length of the trial.

18. Disclosure of Non-party Interested Entities or Persons: Whether each party has filed the "Certification of Interested Entities or Persons" required by Civil Local Rule 3-15. In addition, each party must restate in the case management statement the contents of its certification by identifying any persons, firms, partnerships, corporations (including parent corporations) or other entities known by the party to have either: (i) a financial interest in the subject matter in controversy or in a party to the proceeding; or (ii) any other kind of interest that could be substantially affected by the outcome of the proceeding. In any proposed class, collective, or representative action, the required disclosure includes any person or entity that is funding the prosecution of any claim or counterclaim.

19. Professional Conduct: Whether all attorneys of record for the parties have reviewed the Guidelines for Professional Conduct for the Northern District of California.

20. Such other matters as may facilitate the just, speedy and inexpensive disposition of this matter.